



Youths For Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

Email: youthsaction31@gmail.com

Contact: 0748204272 / 0706072692

Address: Nakuru, Ke

Post-Event Report: Baraget Forest Tree Planting Campaign 2026 – Phase Two

1. Event Overview.

Event Name: Baraget Forest Tree Planting Campaign 2026 – Phase Two

Organized By: Youths for Green Action Kenya

Dates: 15th May 2026 – 17th May 2026

Location: Baraget Forest

Phase Two Achievement

- 50,000 tree seedlings planted during Phase Two
- Cumulative achievement of 100,000 tree seedlings planted under the Baraget Forest Reforestation Initiative
- Approximately 110 acres brought under tree coverage and restoration

Participants.

Community members, Government officials, Kenya Forest Service (KFS), Community Forest Association (CFA), Egerton University representatives, Kenya Meteorological Department officials, media partners, and the Youths for Green Action Kenya team.

Sponsors and Project Patrons; German Imaging Technologies, Victoria Furniture, The Design Gallery

2. Background & Objective

Phase Two of the Baraget Forest Reforestation Initiative built on the momentum and success of the first phase, further advancing the restoration of Baraget Forest as a critical ecological and water catchment ecosystem within the Mau Forest Complex. The campaign continued to strengthen community-centered restoration efforts through active participation by local communities, Community Forest Associations, women groups, youth groups, conservation stakeholders, and institutional partners.

Objectives

- Expand forest restoration coverage through large-scale tree planting
 - Restore degraded forest sections and riparian ecosystems
 - Enhance biodiversity conservation and climate resilience
 - Promote sustainable community participation and ownership in forest conservation
 - Strengthen collaboration between public benefit organizations, government agencies, academic institutions, media, and private sector partners
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3. Execution Summary

The Phase Two exercise was successfully conducted from 15th May 2026 to 17th May 2026 with strong coordination among all stakeholders and partners.

A total of 50,000 tree seedlings were planted during this phase, significantly contributing to the cumulative restoration target of 100,000 trees under the initiative.

The exercise brought together conservation stakeholders from different sectors, including:

- Kenya Forest Service (KFS)
- Community Forest Association (CFA)
- Egerton University
- Kenya Meteorological Department
- Media teams from TV47, NTV, Kenya News Agency, and People's Daily Newspaper

The participation and cooperation from the local community and KFS officers greatly contributed to the success of the campaign, ensuring smooth implementation and effective planting operations throughout the exercise.

The campaign also received strong logistical and institutional support from project sponsors and partners, reinforcing the importance of collaborative environmental restoration initiatives led by young people and communities.

4. Participation

- **Community Members:** Strong community participation and engagement throughout the campaign
 - **Kenya Forest Service (KFS):** Technical support, coordination, and oversight
 - **Community Forest Association (CFA):** Community mobilization and implementation support
 - **Youths for Green Action Kenya:** Core organizing and implementation team
 - **Women & Youth Groups:** Active participation in planting and restoration activities
 - **Egerton University:** Institutional participation and environmental engagement
 - **Kenya Meteorological Department:** Participation and environmental awareness support
 - **Media Partners:** TV47, NTV, Kenya News Agency, and People's Daily coverage and documentation
 - **Project Sponsors & Patrons:** Victoria Furniture, The Design Gallery, and German Imaging Technologies
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5. Tree Planting Breakdown

Exotic Species

- **Quantity:** 45,000 (Cyprus and Bluegum)
- **Purpose:** Forest restoration and timber sustainability
- **Coverage:** Restoration blocks within degraded forest areas

Indigenous Species

- **Quantity:** 5,000 (Syzigium)
 - **Purpose:** Riparian restoration, biodiversity conservation, and water catchment protection
 - **Coverage:** Riparian and ecologically sensitive zones
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6. Key Outcomes & Impact.

- Successful planting of 50,000 tree seedlings during Phase Two
- Achievement of 100,000 cumulative trees planted under the Baraget Forest Reforestation Initiative
- Approximately 110 acres brought under tree coverage and restoration
- Strengthened partnerships between communities, government agencies, institutions, media, and private

sector partners

- Enhanced awareness and participation in climate action and forest conservation
 - Increased community ownership and commitment toward long-term forest restoration and protection efforts
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7. Challenges Encountered.

Despite the overall success of Phase Two, several challenges were observed during implementation.

First, logistical coordination—particularly the transportation and distribution of seedlings within the forest terrain—required continuous adjustment to maintain efficiency across planting zones.

Additionally, differences in volunteer experience levels necessitated on-site orientation and supervision, which slightly affected the initial planting speed. This challenge was effectively managed through the support and guidance of technical officers from KFS and CFA, though it highlighted the importance of conducting pre-event training and briefing sessions for future activities.

Environmental factors, including difficult terrain accessibility within some sections of the forest, also posed minor operational constraints. These conditions affected movement and coordination within the planting sites and required adaptive planning to maintain consistent implementation progress.

8. Mitigation Measures.

The following measures were adopted to address operational challenges during implementation:

- Improved pre-event role allocation and briefing
 - Deployment of team leads for better coordination and supervision
 - Prior mapping of planting zones to improve operational efficiency and movement within the forest
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9. Lessons Learned

Key Lessons

- Early and structured stakeholder engagement significantly improves coordination, accountability, and implementation efficiency.
- Active involvement of donors, technical officers, community volunteers, and institutional partners from

the planning stage contributes to smoother execution and minimizes operational delays.

- Clear role definition and task allocation optimize productivity and reduce duplication of effort among volunteers, media teams, and technical personnel.
 - Integration of real-time data collection and reporting mechanisms strengthens monitoring processes and supports timely decision-making in the field.
 - The involvement of technical experts from KFS and CFA reinforced the importance of quality assurance and adherence to best practices in reforestation activities, which is expected to positively influence seedling survival rates and long-term ecological impact.
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10. Recommendations

Pre-Implementation Training: Conduct structured orientation and briefing sessions for volunteers prior to field activities to enhance preparedness, coordination, and operational efficiency.

Enhanced Logistics Planning: Develop a more detailed logistics framework, including transportation mapping and seedling distribution plans, to better address terrain-related challenges within restoration sites.

Sustainability and Monitoring: Introduce post-planting monitoring mechanisms to track seedling survival rates, assess long-term ecological impact, and strengthen monitoring, evaluation, reporting, and learning (MERL) systems.

Stakeholder Engagement Strategy: Continue strengthening donor, institutional, and community engagement through structured participation frameworks and regular feedback mechanisms.

11. Acknowledgements

We extend sincere appreciation to:

- The **Baraget community** for their commitment and active participation
 - Government agencies including KFS, NEMA, and local administration
 - The **Community Forest Association (CFA)** for coordination and leadership
 - Our sponsors and partners for enabling this initiative
 - The **Youths for Green Action Kenya team** for driving impact on the ground
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12. MERCHANDISE MANAGEMENT AND DISTRIBUTION REPORT.

This report outlines the management and distribution of official merchandise during the Baraget Forest Reforestation Project held from 15th to 17th May 2026. The merchandise played an important role in promoting identity, unity, and visibility among participants, while also recognizing the contribution of different stakeholders.

Objectives of merchandise distribution

- To promote a sense of unity and belonging among volunteers and stakeholders
- To enhance visibility and branding of the project
- To recognize and appreciate the contribution of key partners and participants
- To ensure fair and organized allocation of available resources

Merchandise inventory

To distribute branded merchandise to target participants to support awareness, engagement, and project promotion while ensuring accountability and proper tracking, the merchandise were available for distribution as follows;

- Balance B/F = 9 Caps and 20 T-shirts.
- Newly Printed = 100 caps and 97 T-shirts (60 Round- necked & 37 Polo)

Total merchandise were 109 caps and 117 T-shirts. The t-shirts distribution in sizes were as follows;

Sizes	Bal B/F	Available		Total	Issued	Balance
		Round	Polo			
Small (S)	1	1	8	10	10	0
Medium (M)	4	17	15	36	35	1
Large (L)	9	20	-	29	29	0
Extra Large (XL)	6	15	11	32	26	6
Double Extra Large (2XL)	-	7	3	10	8	2
Total T-shirts	20	60	37	117	108	9
Caps	9	100		109	107	2
Total Merchandise	29	197		227	215	11

The remaining items are reserved for pending allocation of the next phase

Distribution process

The distribution process was carried out in a structured and accountable manner. Priority was given to key stakeholders, organizing teams, and active participants in the project. Records were kept to ensure transparency and proper tracking of issued items. The merchandise were distributed to participants as follows;

Participants	T- shirts	Caps
Donors and Partners (Victoria Furniture Group)	36 (32 Polo,4 Rounded)	34
Secretariats	15 (5 Polo, 10 Rounded)	10
Volunteers and Driver	34	34
Kenya Meteorological Department Officer	1	1
Kenya Forest Service Officers	8	8
Community Forest Association (CFAs)	2	2
Community	12	18
Total	108	107

Challenges

- Limited quantities of merchandise, requiring careful prioritization

Recommendations

- Procurement of sufficient merchandise quantity items to avoid shortages

Conclusion

The merchandise distribution exercise was successfully conducted and achieved its primary objective of promoting awareness and engagement.

13. First Aid Services.

First aid services were provided during the event to ensure the safety and well-being of participants throughout the activities. A total of four individuals were attended to for minor injuries and physical strains sustained during the exercise. The cases included:

- One case of muscle pull.
- Two cases of body strains resulting from physical activities.
- One collarbone injury.

All cases were managed promptly and appropriately, ensuring effective response and participant safety throughout the exercise.

14. Banner Coordination.

Coordination of the organization's branding materials was also undertaken during the event. The organization had two organizational banners available for use during the activity. However, the available banners were insufficient to adequately enhance visibility and branding coverage across the event venue.

Recommendations

To improve branding and visibility during future activities, the following is recommended:

- Procurement of two additional tear drop banners.
- Repair and maintenance of the existing roll-up banner to ensure it remains suitable for future use.